DURHAM STICK MAKERS

Your new website

A practical guide to managing the site - adding sticks, scheduling workshops, writing posts, and keeping everything up to date.

OWNER GUIDE · APRIL 2026

REGISTERED CHARITY 1212357
FENCEHOUSES COMMUNITY CENTRE
COUNTY DURHAM

PREPARED BY
PEACOCK SOLUTIONS

WELCOME

What this guide covers

This document walks you through everything you need to run the Durham Stick Makers website day to day. It covers how visitors experience the site, how to sign in to the admin area, and step-by-step instructions for every task you will regularly need to do.

The site was built so that any member of the committee can manage it with no technical knowledge. If you can fill in a form and drag a photograph, you can run the site.

> **One rule of thumb:** nothing goes live to the public until you explicitly click Publish. You can create drafts, upload images, and experiment freely. Delete or unpublish anything at any time.

THE PUBLIC SITE

What visitors see

The public website has eight main areas, all linked from the top navigation bar. Every page pulls its content from the admin panel, so what you change behind the scenes appears on the site immediately.

Homepage
Hero banner, featured sticks, next workshop, and a warm invitation to get in touch.

The Craft
Illustrated guide to stick types, materials, the making process, and stick care.

Gallery
Filterable photographs with a full-screen lightbox view.

Shop
Product listings with photos, materials, maker credit, and a buy button.

Workshops
Regular session times and bookable workshops with online booking forms.

Journal
Blog posts - technique notes, member spotlights, show reports.

About Us
Your story, mission, member profiles, and Heritage Crafts Red List.

Contact
Message form, workshop address, opening hours, email, social links.

GETTING STARTED

Signing in to admin

The admin area lives at **/admin** on your website. Go to your site URL followed by **/admin/login** and sign in with the email address and password that were set up for you.

1. Open your website in a browser and add **/admin/login** to the end of the URL.
2. Enter your **email** and **password**, then click **Sign in**.
3. You will land on the **Dashboard** - a quick overview showing published products, drafts, pending orders, and upcoming workshops.

Tip: Bookmark the admin login page so you can get back to it quickly. If you forget your password, your developer can reset it through the Supabase dashboard.

The admin sidebar

Once signed in, the left-hand sidebar is your map. Every section of the site you can manage is listed there:

SECTION	WHAT IT DOES
Dashboard	Overview with stat cards and quick links
Products	Add, edit, publish, or archive stick listings and supplies
Workshops	Schedule sessions and view bookings
Orders	View orders placed through the shop
Donations	View donation records
Blog	Write and publish journal posts
Members	Add committee members with photos and bios
Messages	Read messages sent through the contact form
Settings	Edit site-wide information (address, hours, hero text, etc.)

THE MOST IMPORTANT TASK

Adding a stick to the shop

This is the job you will do most often. Each stick is a one-of-a-kind listing with its own photos, description, price, and maker credit.

1. Go to **Products** in the sidebar, then click **+ New listing**.
2. Enter a **title** (e.g. "Ram horn shepherds crook on hazel").
3. Choose the **product type** and pick a **category** from the dropdown.
4. Set the **price** in pounds.
5. **Upload photos** - drag images into the upload zone or click to select files. Upload at least three: full-length, handle close-up, and collar or ferrule. The first image becomes the thumbnail. Drag to reorder.
6. Write a short **description** about the stick's character, materials, and finish.
7. Fill in the **materials** - handle, shank, and collar. The fields offer autocomplete.
8. Select a **maker** from the dropdown so the stick is credited on the site.
9. Tick **Feature on homepage** if you want this stick in the featured row.
10. Click **Save as draft** to come back later, or **Publish** to put it live.

> **When you publish,** the site automatically creates the payment entry in Stripe so the stick can be bought online. If you edit the price later, a new payment entry is created. You do not need to touch Stripe directly.

Editing and archiving

Click any product in the list to edit it. You can change the status between Draft, Published, and Sold at any time. To remove a product permanently, click **Archive** at the bottom of the edit page.

EVENTS

Scheduling a workshop

Beyond the regular Monday and Tuesday drop-in sessions (configured in Settings), you can schedule one-off workshops, taster days, and courses.

1. Go to **Workshops** in the sidebar, then click **+ New workshop**.
2. Enter a **title**, **date**, **start time**, and **end time**.
3. Set the **capacity** and **price** (enter 0 for a free session).
4. Add a **description** and optionally a **featured image**.
5. Click **Save workshop**. It appears on the public Workshops page immediately.

Viewing bookings: When visitors book, their details appear at the bottom of the workshop edit page - name, email, phone, and how many places. If it fills up, the status changes to "Fully booked" automatically.

CONTENT

Writing a blog post

The journal uses a modular block editor. Instead of one big text box, you build your post from blocks - each one a different type of content.

Block types available

Paragraph Regular body text.	**Heading** Large section heading.	**Quote** Pulled quote with attribution.	**Image** Inline photo with caption.
Subheading Smaller heading.	**List** Bulleted or numbered.	**Divider** Visual section break.	**Call to action** Button card with link.

1. Go to **Blog** then **+ New post**. Enter a **title** and **excerpt**.
2. Click **+ Add block** and choose a type. Use arrows to reorder. Add as many as you like.
3. Add a **featured image**, set an **author** and **category**.
4. Click **Save as draft** or **Publish**.

PEOPLE

Managing members

Members appear on the About page and in the "Made by" dropdown on products.

1. Go to **Members**, click **+ Add member**.
2. Enter **name**, a short **bio**, and upload a **portrait photo**.
3. Set **display order** (lower = first on the About page). Leave **Active** ticked.
4. Click **Save member**.

COMMUNICATION

Reading messages

When somebody fills in the contact form, their message appears in **Messages**. Unread messages have a brass dot. Click to expand - it auto-marks as read. Click **Reply by email** to open your mail client with the address and subject pre-filled.

CONFIGURATION

Site settings

The Settings page lets you edit information that appears across the entire site. Changes take effect immediately when you click **Save settings**.

SETTING	WHERE IT APPEARS
Charity name & number	Footer on every page, About page
Contact email	Contact page, footer
Hero headline & subtitle	Homepage banner
"Get involved" text	Homepage support block
Workshop address	Footer, Contact, About page
Regular sessions	Homepage, Workshops, Contact, footer
Opening hours note	Alongside session times
Instagram & Facebook	Footer social icons
Shipping rates	Checkout (standard, oversized, free threshold)

PHOTOGRAPHY

Tips for good photographs

Natural light
A window or shade beats a flash every time.

Three angles
Full length, handle close-up, collar detail.

Clean backgrounds
A plain surface or bench. No clutter.

Phone is fine
Modern phone camera is plenty. Wipe the lens.

QUICK REFERENCE

At a glance

To add a stick to the shop

Products → + New listing → fill in details → upload photos → Publish

To schedule a workshop

Workshops → + New workshop → set date, time, capacity, price → Save

To write a blog post

Blog → + New post → title, excerpt → add blocks → Publish

To add a member

Members → + Add member → name, bio, photo → Save

To read a contact message

Messages → click the message → Reply by email

To change the opening hours

Settings → Regular sessions → edit days and times → Save settings

To update the homepage headline

Settings → Hero headline → type new text → Save settings

To feature a stick on the homepage

Products → edit the stick → tick "Feature on homepage" → Save

To mark a stick as sold

Products → edit the stick → change status to Sold (or it happens automatically via Stripe checkout)

To cancel a workshop

Workshops → edit the workshop → click "Cancel workshop" at the bottom

> **If something goes wrong:** check the admin panel first - most issues are a toggle or a status change away. For data questions, check the Supabase dashboard. For anything else, contact your developer.